arsenal. It is hard enough to expect nuclear transparency within democratic systems, given the high level of classification required by even the most routine nuclear missions. It may well be that Kim cannot risk instituting anything near the level of America's nuclear safety regime, since dictators rule by instilling fear, not trust. Equally, Kim may feel there is no need to do so, since he has undoubtedly been assured of the program's unquestioned success.

All this raises the question of accountability. As retired air force lieutenant general James Kowalski, a B-52 pilot and the former deputy commander of US Strategic Command, put it, "Who is going to be the guy who goes to Kim Jong-un and tells him he has a problem with his nukes?"[8] Absolute trust is required between leaders and those charged with maintaining and operating nuclear weapons. It is hard to imagine such trust existing among Kim's circle of terrified sycophants.

IV.

Let's assume for the moment that Kim Jong-un's technicians and maintainers manage to keep his missiles safe and operationally reliable. The next major piece of the nuclear surety puzzle is people. Not surprisingly, dealing with the world's most powerful weapons requires an extraordinarily highly qualified cadre of specialists and some of the most rigorous training of any military specialty. Even so, US military personnel have made grave errors, including a 2007 incident when six nuclear-tipped cruise missiles were mistakenly loaded onto a B-52 that flew from Minot Air Force Base in North Dakota to Barksdale Air Force Base in Louisiana and sat unprotected on the runway at Barksdale for thirty-six hours.[9]

Operational mistakes by nuclear personnel are not the only dangers facing the nuclear enterprise. "We are continuously moving towards zero mistakes," Kowalski noted, acknowledging that even minor accidents in the nuclear enterprise can be catastrophic. Yet others have argued that the pressure to make no mistakes leads unintentionally to